

Measurement of Proton-Tagged Charged-Current Single-Charged-Pion Production on Argon in the NuMI Beam with the MicroBooNE Detector

Companion to the inclusive analysis note

Secondary results proposed for approval and validation-only products

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Abstract

The inclusive $\text{CC}\pi^\pm$ measurement of the companion note is repeated on the subsample in which a proton candidate with $p_p > 0.3 \text{ GeV}/c$ is also reconstructed. The proton gives access to the visible hadronic system: the proton momentum and direction, the pion-proton opening angle, a calorimetric hadronic-mass proxy and the transverse kinematic imbalance between the muon and the πp system. The cross sections are averaged over the $\nu_\mu + \bar{\nu}_\mu$ flux integrated above 60 MeV and extracted in the FHC, RHC and combined configurations with the Wiener-SVD machinery of the inclusive analysis, each with its additional-smearing matrix and covariance. The one-bin total cross section, $d\sigma/d\theta_p$ and $d\sigma/d\theta_{\pi p}$, and the combined-configuration $d^2\sigma/d\theta_p d\delta p_T$ are proposed as secondary results. The proton momentum, the hadronic-mass proxy, the transverse-kinematic-imbalance observables and the muon and pion observables on this sample are validation-only products until an inverted-proton-PID control region exists, the hadronic-mass and p_n prescriptions are validated for pion production, and the model sensitivity of the low-imbalance bins (1.1–1.2 σ under a coherent GENIE variation) is treated. No differential $W_{\pi p}$ result is reported. The one-bin total carries a 42–47% uncertainty; ensembles of pseudo-experiments give pull widths of 0.94–1.08. All results are extracted from pseudo-data.

Contents

1	Summary and decision requested	1
2	Introduction	1
3	Signal definition and selection	2
3.1	What the proton candidate is	3

4	Observables and binning	3
5	Extraction and uncertainties	5
5.1	Muon momentum scale	5
5.2	Effects not included in the covariance	6
6	Validation	6
6.1	Closure under the nominal model	7
6.2	Statistical coverage	8
6.3	Robustness to a different interaction model	9
7	Results proposed for approval	10
7.1	Total cross section	10
7.2	Proton angles θ_p and $\theta_{\pi p}$	10
7.3	Two-dimensional $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$	11
8	Validation-only products	12
8.1	Differential cross sections	12
9	Products not reported	17
9.1	The differential $W_{\pi p}$ shape is not reported	17
10	Prerequisites	18
11	Summary	19
	Glossary	20

1 Summary and decision requested

This note presents the proton-tagged measurement, the inclusive $\text{CC}\pi^\pm$ selection with a reconstructed proton above $0.3 \text{ GeV}/c$. All results are extracted from pseudo-data: the signal region is blind. The decision requested is stated below; the same statement opens the analysis note.

Decision requested from the collaboration

1. Approve the inclusive $\text{CC}\pi^\pm$ signal definition, selection, extraction and uncertainty model, and the reported inclusive observables, each as a Primary result: $d\sigma/dp_\mu$, $d\sigma/d\cos\theta_\mu$, $d\sigma/d\cos\theta_\pi$, $d\sigma/d\theta_{\mu\pi}$, the cross section in three p_π regions and the one-bin total cross section, each in the FHC, RHC and combined configurations.
2. Do not yet authorise opening of the inclusive signal region: the prerequisites U1–U6 of Table 12 remain to be completed.
3. Approve the following, each as a Secondary result proposed for approval: the proton-tagged one-bin total cross section and the proton-tagged $d\sigma/d\theta_p$ and $d\sigma/d\theta_{\pi p}$ (FHC, RHC, combined), and the two-dimensional results $d^2\sigma/d\theta_p d\delta p_T$ (proton-tagged sample) and $d^2\sigma/d\cos\theta_\pi d\cos\theta_\mu$ (inclusive sample) in the combined configuration only, subject to the prerequisites listed for each in Table 12.
4. Treat every other proton-tagged extraction (p_p , W_{had} , δp_T , $\delta\alpha_T$, $\delta\phi_T$, p_n and the muon and pion observables on the proton-tagged sample) as a Validation-only product.
5. Do not report the differential $W_{\pi p}$ result, the other two-dimensional pairs, or the FHC and RHC extractions of the two two-dimensional results (Not reported).

Table 1 gives the status of every proton-tagged product and the prerequisites that block it (Table 12, Section 10). No differential $W_{\pi p}$ result is reported. The topology-level one-bin total cross section remains measurable, but it is not described as a $W_{\pi p}$ measurement.

Table 1: Status of every proton-tagged product, generated from `report/status.tsv`. “yes” marks the configurations in which a product is reported under its status; the prerequisites are those of Table 12.

Product	FHC	RHC	Comb.	Status	Prerequisites
One-bin total cross section	yes	yes	yes	Secondary result proposed for approval	U1–U3, U5–U7, P1
$d\sigma/d\theta_p$, $d\sigma/d\theta_{\pi p}$	yes	yes	yes	Secondary result proposed for approval	U1–U3, U5–U7, P1, P2
$d^2\sigma/d\theta_p d\delta p_T$	no	no	yes	Secondary result proposed for approval	U1–U7, P1–P3, R1
$d\sigma/dp_p$	yes	yes	yes	Validation-only product	P1
$d\sigma/dW_{\text{had}}$ (two regions)	yes	yes	yes	Validation-only product	P1, P4
$d\sigma/d\delta p_T$, $d\sigma/dp_n$	yes	yes	yes	Validation-only product	P1, P3, P4
$d\sigma/d\delta\alpha_T$, $d\sigma/d\delta\phi_T$	yes	yes	yes	Validation-only product	P1
p_μ , p_π (two regions), $\cos\theta_\mu$, $\cos\theta_\pi$, $\theta_{\mu\pi}$ on the proton-tagged sample	yes	yes	yes	Validation-only product	P1
$d\sigma/dW_{\pi p}$				Not reported	
Two-dimensional $\theta_p \times W_{\pi p}$, $\theta_{\pi p} \times W_{\pi p}$, $\theta_{\pi p} \times \delta p_T$; FHC and RHC $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$				Not reported	

2 Introduction

The inclusive analysis [11] measures charged-current single-charged-pion production with any number of nucleons in the final state. Requiring in addition a reconstructed proton gives access to the whole visible hadronic system and to observables that the inclusive measurement cannot

provide.

The proposed results address three questions. The one-bin total measures how often a $CC\pi^\pm$ interaction produces a proton above $0.3\text{ GeV}/c$, which depends on the resonance decay, on nucleon final-state interactions and on the nuclear model: among the generators the ratio of the proton-tagged to the inclusive FHC total ranges from 0.52 (NuWro) to 0.65 (GiBUU), with 0.61 for the tune. The proton-tagged totals themselves span 0.50 (GENIE) to $0.78 \times 10^{-38}\text{ cm}^2/\text{Ar}$ (NEUT) in FHC, against a 42–47% uncertainty on the measured total, so at the present exposure the total separates only the lowest and highest predictions, by about one standard deviation. The proton polar angle θ_p measures the proton direction, and the pion–proton opening angle $\theta_{\pi p}$ how the momentum of the hadronic system is shared between the pion and the proton, which the transverse-kinematic-imbalance (TKI) observables of the summed system cannot see. The two-dimensional $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$ relates the proton direction to the transverse imbalance.

The other differential products, the hadronic-mass proxy W_{had} , the TKI observables and the proton momentum, are validation-only. They are extracted, validated and released with the same chain, and they show where the proton-tagged extraction is sensitive to the model, but they are not proposed until the prerequisites of Section 10 are met.

The proton requirement changes more than the sample size. The signal definition acquires a proton threshold and a leading-proton convention. The reconstruction acquires a proton candidate that is the leading true proton in 82% of selected signal events. Two observables, p_n and the hadronic-mass proxy, rely on a single-nucleon residual-mass prescription written for quasi-elastic kinematics and not yet validated for pion production. The detector uncertainty, evaluated on the smaller sample, reaches 75% in the sparsest extractions. The inclusive measurement carries none of these, and the two analyses are therefore documented and approved separately. Table 2 lists what this note takes from the analysis note and what it defines itself.

Table 2: Where each element of the proton-tagged measurement is defined.

Element	Defined in
Beam, exposure, flux and target count	Sec. 5 of the inclusive analysis note
Samples, event weights and beam-off normalisation	Sec. 6 of the inclusive analysis note
Base selection (ten cuts)	Sec. 9 of the inclusive analysis note
Unfolding and additional-smearing matrix A_C	Sec. 12 of the inclusive analysis note
Shared uncertainty model	Sec. 13 of the inclusive analysis note
Migration criterion and binning rule	Sec. 12.3 of the inclusive analysis note
Proton requirement, signal and proton candidate	Section 3
Proton-tagged observables and binnings	Section 4
Proton-specific uncertainties	Section 5
Validation of the proton-tagged extractions	Section 6
Prerequisites	Section 10

3 Signal definition and selection

Signal. The signal is the inclusive signal of Sec. 7 of the inclusive analysis note with at least one true proton above $0.3\text{ GeV}/c$; the muon and pion phase space is unchanged. The truth-level proton observables use the leading proton, the one of highest momentum.

Selection. The ten inclusive cuts of Sec. 9.2 of the inclusive analysis note are applied unchanged, followed by an eleventh cut that identifies the proton:

Requirement	Threshold	Description
Candidate set	–	track-like primaries other than the muon and pion candidates
Proton likeness	LLR PID < 0.05	the most proton-like of the set is the candidate
Containment	end point in FV	range-based momentum is meaningful only if contained
Momentum	$p_p \geq 0.3 \text{ GeV}/c$	tracking threshold; below it protons are not reconstructed reliably

The proton momentum is computed from the proton-hypothesis kinetic energy of the candidate track, which is obtained from its range, as $p_p = \sqrt{T_p^2 + 2m_p T_p}$. On truth-matched FHC simulation it underestimates the true momentum by 9% on average, with a resolution of 21%; both are part of the response matrix.

Performance. At full exposure the selection has an efficiency of 11.5% and a purity of 52% in FHC (50% in RHC, 51% combined), against 17.5% and 59% for the inclusive selection. Relative to the inclusive final cut evaluated under the proton-tagged signal definition, the proton requirement rejects 67% of the neutrino background for a 32% loss of signal, raises the purity from 34% to 52% and improves $S/\sqrt{B}$ from 17.1 to 20.5 (FHC). It also rejects cosmic rays: a contained proton above 0.3 GeV/ c reduces the beam-off background by a factor 3.3–3.6 at the final cut and by up to six in the CC0 π control region (Sec. 21.7 of the technical supplement). The cut-flow by stage and category is Table 15 of the technical supplement (stacks in Fig. 6 of the technical supplement); it uses the per-run exposure scaling of the inclusive cut-flow (Table 12 of the inclusive analysis note), and its final row gives the counts of Table 8.

3.1 What the proton candidate is

On selected signal events the proton candidate is the leading true proton in 81.7% of cases, some true proton in 87.4%, and not a proton in 12.6% (10 105 simulated events). The wrong candidates are mainly charged pions or other tracks taken for the proton.

The effect of a wrong candidate was measured for the two angular observables. A correct candidate reconstructs the angle precisely, with an interquartile range of the residual of 0.073 rad in θ_p and 0.124 rad in $\theta_{\pi p}$. A wrong candidate gives an angle unrelated to the true one: the interquartile range is 1.0–1.4 rad, and three quarters of those events have residuals beyond 0.3 rad. The core resolution averaged over all events is only a quarter to a third wider than that of correct candidates, but the migrations between bins come from the tails: residuals beyond 0.3 rad occur in 18.9% of θ_p events, and 74% of them are wrong candidates (25.9% and 51% for $\theta_{\pi p}$). The candidate purity is therefore the main source of bin-to-bin migration in θ_p , whose smallest migration diagonal is 0.69 in FHC and 0.68 in RHC at the adopted edges.

The same wrong-candidate rate applies to $W_{\pi p}$, W_{had} and the TKI observables, which use the same candidate; the attribution of the migrations was measured for the angles only. The multi- π control region of the inclusive analysis receives otherwise-signal events whose proton fails the proton-likeness requirement, since the pion count uses the same PID cut. It constrains the proton→pion direction, not the pion→proton direction that produces the 12.6%, and it is the region with the largest signal content. A control region that inverts the proton PID at exactly one pion candidate would separate the two directions (Sec. 21.6 of the technical supplement).

4 Observables and binning

Definitions. All observables are built from the three candidate tracks with reconstructed quantities only: the range or multiple-scattering momentum of the muon, the range momentum of the pion, the range kinetic energy of the proton and the track directions. Angles and transverse

quantities are taken about the neutrino direction of Sec. 5.2 of the inclusive analysis note, the same convention as the inclusive analysis and the generator predictions.

- The proton momentum p_p is that of the candidate; at truth level it is the momentum of the leading proton.
- The πp invariant mass, $W_{\pi p} = [(E_\pi + E_p)^2 - (\vec{p}_\pi + \vec{p}_p)^2]^{1/2}$, is measured directly and needs no neutrino direction.
- The calorimetric hadronic-mass proxy, $W_{\text{had}} = [m_p^2 + 2m_p(E_{\text{cal}} - E_\mu) - Q^2]^{1/2}$, is built from the reconstructed calorimetric energy E_{cal} and Q^2 .
- The TKI observables are the transverse-momentum imbalance δp_T , its angles $\delta\alpha_T$ and $\delta\phi_T$ [8], and the inferred nucleon-momentum proxy p_n [9], computed from the muon against the summed $(\pi + p)$ system with the STV tool of the framework after rotating both into the frame in which the neutrino defines the z axis.
- The proton polar angle and the pion–proton opening angle,

$$\theta_p = \arccos(\hat{p}_p \cdot \hat{\nu}), \quad \theta_{\pi p} = \arccos(\hat{p}_\pi \cdot \hat{p}_p),$$

of which $\theta_{\pi p}$ is an angle between two reconstructed tracks and does not depend on the neutrino direction.

The five muon and pion observables of the inclusive analysis (p_μ , p_π , $\cos\theta_\mu$, $\cos\theta_\pi$, $\theta_{\mu\pi}$) are measured again on the proton-tagged phase space. The formulae and the conventions of the TKI tool are given in Sec. 10.1 of the technical supplement.

The TKI observables and W_{had} are built from the summed hadronic system and are insensitive to how its momentum is shared between the pion and the proton; $\theta_{\pi p}$ measures that sharing. θ_p is the proton direction itself, of which the other observables use only derived quantities.

Binning. Every binning meets the 0.50 migration criterion of the inclusive analysis with at least 50 selected FHC signal events per bin (Sec. 8 of the technical supplement; Table 3): p_p in three bins split at 0.42 and 0.60 GeV/ c with an open upper bin, W_{had} in two regions split at 1.18 GeV/ c^2 , $\delta\phi_T$ in three bins, δp_T , $\delta\alpha_T$ and p_n in two, and θ_p and $\theta_{\pi p}$ in four each, at edges that maximise the smallest migration diagonal. The muon and pion observables use the inclusive edges, except p_π , which has two regions because the three inclusive regions fail the criterion in this sample, and $\cos\theta_\pi$, which has four bins. The RHC and combined samples use the FHC binnings.

Table 3: Bin edges of the proton-tagged observables, from the result files. The binnings meet the 0.50 migration criterion (Sec. 8 of the technical supplement) and are the same in the three configurations.

Observable	Bins	Edges
p_μ (GeV/c)	6	0.15, 0.3, 0.425, 0.575, 0.825, 1.25, 3*
p_π (GeV/c)	2	0.175, 0.205, 1*
$\cos \theta_\mu$	8	-1, 0.4, 0.625, 0.75, 0.825, 0.9, 0.95, 0.975, 1
$\cos \theta_\pi$	4	-1, -0.1, 0.35, 0.75, 1
$\theta_{\mu\pi}$ (rad)	5	0, 0.6, 0.85, 1.3, 1.85, 2.6
$W_{\pi p}$ (GeV/c ²)	6	1.08, 1.19, 1.23, 1.27, 1.34, 1.47, 2.9*
W_{had} (GeV/c ²)	2	0, 1.18, 2.74*
δp_T (GeV/c)	2	0, 0.3, 2.5*
$\delta \phi_T$ (deg)	3	0, 22.5, 75, 180
$\delta \alpha_T$ (deg)	2	0, 120, 180
p_n (GeV/c)	2	0, 0.375, 2*
p_p (GeV/c)	3	0.3, 0.42, 0.6, 1.5*
θ_p (rad) [†]	4	0, 0.44, 0.785, 1.162, π
$\theta_{\pi p}$ (rad) [†]	4	0, 0.911, 1.414, 1.916, π

[†] Released as a Secondary result proposed for approval (§7.2).

* Numerical plotting boundary only: the upper truth bin is open-ended, and a density drawn over the conventional width represents the bin integral.

5 Extraction and uncertainties

Each observable is extracted as in the inclusive analysis: the selected spectrum is scaled per run to the recorded exposure, the neutrino, beam-off and dirt backgrounds are subtracted, and the result is unfolded with the Wiener-SVD method [1] and the smearceptance matrix of the proton-tagged signal (Sec. 12 of the inclusive analysis note). Every result is provided with its additional-smearing matrix A_C , through which a prediction must be passed before comparison, and with its covariance by source (Sec. 15.4 of the inclusive analysis note). The combined configuration is an independent extraction with its own response and A_C , not an average of FHC and RHC. The two families of processed files store the simulated exposure under different conventions, and the run-by-run normalisation is correct under both (Sec. 10.1 of the technical supplement).

The covariance contains the flux, cross-section, re-interaction, detector, POT, target-count and statistical terms of the inclusive analysis. The detector term ranges from 9.9% to 74.5% (median 30.9%) against 16.6–34.2% for the inclusive results. It is of the same size in most extractions, as expected for the same detector, and largest in the sparsest ones (RHC p_n and the six-bin $W_{\pi p}$, both near 74%), where the unfolding amplifies the variations. The flux term of the one-bin total is 35.5% in FHC. As in the inclusive analysis it is the flux normalisation multiplied by $1 + B/S$ through the background subtraction (Sec. 13.2 of the inclusive analysis note): $17.7\% \times (1 + 298/331) = 33.6\%$, the difference from the inclusive factor reflecting the purity of this sample.

5.1 Muon momentum scale

The muon momentum scale is varied as in the inclusive analysis (Sec. 13.3 of the inclusive analysis note): in the pseudo-data alone, every muon whose momentum is measured by multiple Coulomb scattering is scaled by 1 ± 0.05 , while the simulation, the response and the selection stay nominal, and each variation is unfolded with the nominal response. The half-difference of the two results is taken as a fully correlated term. In this sample the muon momentum also enters W_{had} , δp_T , $\delta \alpha_T$ and p_n , which are therefore recomputed from the scaled muon for every event with

a proton candidate (`macros/mcs_scale_fakedata_1p.C`); with a scale of one the recomputed values reproduce the stored ones exactly. $\delta\phi_T$ depends only on the muon direction, and $W_{\pi p}$, p_p , p_π and the angles do not use the muon momentum, so their term is zero.

Table 4 gives the result. The largest term is in the open highest p_μ bin, 24% of the bin value and 0.62σ of its uncertainty in FHC; the lower p_μ bins move by 8–15%, as in the inclusive analysis. For the derived observables the term is at most 0.37σ : it is largest in the lower W_{had} region (16–34%, 0.23 – 0.37σ), in the upper p_n bin (18–24%) and in the lower $\delta\alpha_T$ bin (11–13%), and it is below 0.15σ for δp_T . For the two-bin δp_T the downward scale moves as many selected events across the edge at $0.3\text{ GeV}/c$ in one direction as in the other, so its result equals the nominal one and the half-difference is set by the upward scale alone. Adding the term raises the per-bin total uncertainty by at most 18% of itself for p_μ (FHC) and by at most 7% for the derived observables. The term is part of the official covariance of every result: it is released as `cov_MCSscale.txt`, and `cov_total_plusMCS.txt` is the framework covariance plus this term (`data_release/mcs_scale_1p_2026-09-27.tsv`). Every uncertainty quoted in this note includes it; the closure χ^2 and the robustness biases are quoted with the framework covariance.

Table 4: Muon momentum-scale term ($\pm 5\%$ on the MCS-measured muons of the fake data) for the proton-tagged observables that use the muon momentum: the change of the integral for the upward and downward scale, and the largest per-bin half-difference as a fraction of the bin value and in units of the total uncertainty of that bin.

Config	Observable	up / nominal	down / nominal	largest half-diff.	in σ
FHC	p_μ	0.967	1.013	24.3%	0.62
	W_{had}	1.018	0.986	15.7%	0.23
	δp_T	0.986	1.000	7.2%	0.10
	$\delta\alpha_T$	0.945	1.054	10.7%	0.24
	p_n	1.004	0.997	24.4%	0.24
RHC	p_μ	1.001	1.015	12.3%	0.30
	W_{had}	1.058	0.973	32.6%	0.33
	δp_T	0.969	1.000	3.6%	0.09
	$\delta\alpha_T$	0.921	1.085	12.6%	0.33
	p_n	0.998	1.001	22.1%	0.16
Combined	p_μ	0.996	1.018	18.1%	0.51
	W_{had}	1.035	0.980	33.5%	0.37
	δp_T	0.941	1.000	3.1%	0.13
	$\delta\alpha_T$	0.936	1.066	12.0%	0.29
	p_n	0.986	1.007	18.6%	0.27

5.2 Effects not included in the covariance

The beamline-geometry flux term, the uncertainty of the beam-off gate ratios and the use of the Run-1 beam-off sample for Run 2 are bounded in the inclusive note (Sec. 13.4 of the inclusive analysis note) and are not included in the official covariance (U7). The beam-off background of the proton-tagged sample is three to four times smaller than that of the inclusive sample, so the last two are smaller still.

6 Validation

The validation follows the ladder of the inclusive analysis (Sec. 14 of the inclusive analysis note; Table 5): closure under the nominal model, statistical coverage with ensembles, and robustness to a different interaction model are done for the proton-tagged extractions listed below, the

results proposed for approval among them (V1), and the generator and control-region steps are prerequisites (U2, U3, P1).

Table 5: Validation ladder. Each step asks a question that the steps before it cannot answer; closure under the nominal model is necessary but not sufficient, since a result can close while being determined largely by the modelled migrations or by the regularisation, which the migration criterion and the trace of A_C address separately (Sec. 12.3 of the inclusive analysis note).

Step	Question	Status	Criterion	Worst case observed	Blocks
1. Implementation closure	Does the chain return the truth of pseudo-data thrown from the model of the response?	Done for every extraction	Unfolded result consistent with the A_C -smeared truth; integral ratio within the statistical spread	Inclusive: $\chi^2 \leq 2.39/8$, integral ratios 0.946–1.047. Proton-tagged: $\chi^2 \leq 6.01/4$ (RHC $\cos \theta_\pi$), ratios 0.93–1.18; two-dimensional: cell ratios 0.70–1.36	Unblinding
2. Statistical calibration	Are the quoted statistical uncertainties correctly sized?	Done: seven inclusive and ten proton-tagged extractions, 100 pseudo-experiments each, among them θ_p and $\theta_{\pi p}$ in every configuration and the two two-dimensional results (V1)	Pull width consistent with one within the ensemble precision ($\pm 13\%$ at 100 members); coverage 68% and 95%	Inclusive: widths 0.95–1.07, 68% coverage 63–73%; the sparsest two-dimensional cell lies 0.58 statistical standard deviations low on average. Proton-tagged: widths 0.94–1.08, 62–72%	Unblinding
3. Parametric robustness	Does the extraction follow a different model that reweighting can reach?	Done: GENIE multisim universe 545 and $\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular, inclusive FHC and RHC, proton-tagged FHC including θ_p and $\theta_{\pi p}$, and the two-dimensional results in the combined configuration (V1)	Per-bin bias against the per-bin total uncertainty; a bias above 1σ is flagged and treated	Inclusive: 1.18σ in one sparse bin (FHC $\cos \theta_\mu$). Proton-tagged: -1.14σ and -1.16σ in the low δp_T and p_n bins (P3). θ_p , $\theta_{\pi p}$ and the two-dimensional results: at most 0.79σ	Unblinding
4. Structural robustness	Does it close on pseudo-data from a generator that reweighting cannot reach?	Outstanding (U3)	Criterion of U3	n/a	Unblinding
5. Background validation	Do control-region data support the background model?	Outstanding (U2; P1 for the proton mis-assignment)	Frozen procedure of the control regions	n/a	Unblinding
6. Signal-region opening	Are the normalisation and covariance prerequisites complete?	Outstanding	U1–U6 complete	n/a	n/a

6.1 Closure under the nominal model

The pseudo-data are unfolded and compared with the A_C -smeared truth of the throw (Tables 9–11). In FHC the χ^2 is well below the number of bins for every observable, and the integral ratios are 0.93–1.18. These ratios compare the unfolded result with the A_C -smeared truth, so the A_C

suppression cancels and the departures from unity reflect the statistical realisation of the throw and any residual bias; the largest are in $\cos\theta_\mu$ (1.18) and $\delta\alpha_T$ (0.93). In RHC and combined the closure gives $\chi^2/\text{ndf} \lesssim 1$ for every observable except RHC $\cos\theta_\pi$ (6.0/4). As in the inclusive analysis, the systematic terms are common to the pseudo-data and the reference, so the closure p -values cluster near unity and the statistical coverage is tested with ensembles.

6.2 Statistical coverage

Ten extractions were repeated on 100 statistically independent pseudo-data sets each, with the procedure of the inclusive ensembles (Sec. 18 of the technical supplement). Every member is a run-by-run Poisson throw of the central-value prediction carried through the whole chain: the universes are rebuilt from the throw and the result is unfolded. Each unfolded bin is compared with the fixed central-value truth smeared by that member’s own A_C ,

$$p_i = \frac{\hat{x}_i - (A_C x_{\text{CV}})_i}{\sigma_i}.$$

Three of them span the validation-only products: W_{had} in two regions in FHC, the two-bin δp_T in FHC, and the two-bin p_n in the combined configuration, which also exercises the combination of the beam modes. The other seven are the differential results proposed for approval: θ_p and $\theta_{\pi p}$ in each configuration and $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$ in the combined configuration. For all 5600 input files the number of events read by the universe builder agrees with the entries on disk, so no member read an incomplete file.

Table 6: Proton-tagged pseudo-data ensembles, 100 members each. Pulls of the unfolded bins against the central-value truth smeared by each member’s own A_C , in units of the statistical uncertainty (mean, width, fraction within 1σ and 1.96σ) and of the full uncertainty (width), the offset of the ensemble-mean integral from the reference integral (in brackets: in standard errors of the mean) and the member-to-member spread of the integral. Expected: mean 0, width 1, coverage 68% and 95% (`data_release/ensemble_1p_2026-09-26.tsv`, `ensemble_v1_2026-09-28.tsv`).

Extraction	Config.	statistical				full	integral	
		mean	width	68%	95%	width	offset	spread
<i>Validation-only products</i>								
W_{had} (2 regions)	FHC	−0.05	0.94	72%	97%	0.26	−0.4% (−0.4)	8.3%
δp_T (2 bins)	FHC	−0.04	1.08	62%	92%	0.40	−0.6% (−0.8)	7.8%
p_n (2 bins)	combined	−0.04	0.99	64%	96%	0.31	−0.3% (−0.6)	5.2%
<i>Secondary results proposed for approval</i>								
θ_p	FHC	−0.09	1.01	68%	94%	0.39	−1.0% (−0.8)	11.7%
	RHC	−0.04	0.97	70%	96%	0.37	−1.3% (−1.4)	9.4%
	combined	−0.12	1.03	65%	95%	0.32	−1.2% (−1.5)	8.2%
$\theta_{\pi p}$	FHC	−0.02	1.00	67%	94%	0.40	−0.2% (−0.3)	8.0%
	RHC	−0.06	0.94	72%	96%	0.26	−0.7% (−0.8)	8.3%
	combined	−0.01	1.02	65%	94%	0.35	+0.1% (+0.1)	9.2%
$\theta_p \times \delta p_T$	combined	−0.05	1.04	67%	94%	0.40	−0.6% (−1.3)	5.1%

Against the statistical covariance the pull widths are 0.94–1.08, each known to about $\pm 7\%$, and the 68% and 95% coverages are 62–72% and 92–97%. The widest case is the two-bin δp_T (width 1.08, 68% coverage 62%), within two standard deviations of nominal; its two bins are correlated, so its 200 pulls are fewer than 200 independent tests. Bin by bin, every mean is within 0.27 of zero and every width is 0.84–1.10. The narrowest, in the first RHC $\theta_{\pi p}$ bin, means that the statistical uncertainty of that bin is about 20% larger than the spread of its unfolded values, which is conservative. The statistical uncertainties of the proton-tagged results are therefore correctly sized.

Against the full covariance the widths are 0.26–0.40. The systematic part of the uncertainty is two to three times the statistical part, as in the inclusive analysis, and the ensembles do not test it, since every member is thrown from the same central-value model; that is the role of the alternative-model test below. The ensemble-mean integrals lie between 1.3% below and 0.1% above the reference, at most 1.5 standard errors of the mean, the small negative offset common to the inclusive ensembles (Sec. 14.2 of the inclusive analysis note). The other proton-tagged observables were not run individually.

6.3 Robustness to a different interaction model

The pseudo-data are thrown from a reweighted interaction model and unfolded with the nominal response (Sec. 14.3 of the inclusive analysis note). The two variations of the inclusive analysis are used, GENIE multisim universe 545, a coherent variation of all interaction parameters, and the $\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ decay-angle unisim, with the same universes and seeds; the weight applies to signal and background alike. W_{had} , the four TKI observables, $\cos\theta_\pi$ and p_p are extracted in FHC. The truth of the pseudo-data is that of the alternative model, so the closure measures the bias from the model mismatch, quoted in units of the per-bin uncertainty (Table 7).

Table 7: Alternative-model closure of the proton-tagged extractions, FHC: unfolded result against the alternative model’s own truth. “ratio” is the mean unfolded/truth over bins holding at least 10% of the largest truth; “bias” is the largest per-bin deviation in units of the uncertainty of that bin, over every bin. $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$ is extracted in the combined configuration, the only one in which it is proposed; its cells are numbered outer slice by outer slice (δp_T below and above 0.3 GeV/c), θ_p fastest.

Observable	Variation	ratio	max. deviation	bias (bin)
<i>Validation-only products</i>				
W_{had} (2 regions)	GENIE u545	0.83	29%	-0.40σ (1)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	1.23	58%	$+0.89\sigma$ (1)
δp_T (2 bins)	GENIE u545	0.66	35%	-1.14σ (1)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	1.04	4%	$+0.14\sigma$ (1)
$\delta\alpha_T$ (2 bins)	GENIE u545	0.85	24%	-0.57σ (1)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	1.03	8%	$+0.19\sigma$ (2)
$\delta\phi_T$ (3 bins)	GENIE u545	0.78	38%	-0.60σ (2)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	1.22	51%	$+0.85\sigma$ (2)
p_n (2 bins)	GENIE u545	1.01	34%	-1.16σ (1)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	1.08	15%	$+0.16\sigma$ (2)
$\cos\theta_\pi$	GENIE u545	0.96	10%	-0.37σ (1)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	0.94	24%	-0.55σ (3)
p_p (3 bins)	GENIE u545	0.92	9%	-0.19σ (2)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	1.08	17%	$+0.37\sigma$ (1)
<i>Secondary results proposed for approval</i>				
θ_p	GENIE u545	0.82	28%	-0.79σ (2)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	1.12	29%	$+0.75\sigma$ (3)
$\theta_{\pi p}$	GENIE u545	0.89	20%	-0.31σ (1)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	1.04	38%	$+0.67\sigma$ (1)
$\theta_p \times \delta p_T$	GENIE u545	0.94	26%	-0.68σ (2)
	$\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ angular	0.95	61%	-0.74σ (3)

Under the $\Delta \rightarrow N\pi$ variation no bin exceeds 0.9σ , although the two W_{had} regions and the three $\delta\phi_T$ bins return 22–23% high on average. Under the coherent GENIE variation the low δp_T and p_n bins, the small-imbalance region closest to quasi-elastic kinematics, return 35% below the alternative truth, -1.1 and -1.2σ , while that truth moved by only 1%. The shift therefore enters through the response and the background, through the change the varied model makes

to the composition of the proton-tagged sample and to the proton-tagging efficiency, which the nominal response does not follow. The inclusive analysis shows a bias of this size in one sparse bin only (Sec. 14.3 of the inclusive analysis note). The uncertainty covers the shift at about one standard deviation, so the extraction does not fail, but the small-imbalance bins of the TKI observables are model-sensitive at the level of their own uncertainty. A measurement in them needs either this model dependence in the covariance or a demonstration with a validated independent generator that the shift does not occur.

The results proposed for approval stay within 0.8σ in every bin. Under the GENIE variation all four θ_p bins return low, 0.72–0.91 of the alternative truth, while that truth changed by -3% ; the largest bias is -0.79σ , in the second bin. The integral of the FHC θ_p extraction varies by 12% from one pseudo-data set to the next (§6.2), so a single throw cannot separate a model effect of this size from a fluctuation; in either case every bin stays below 1σ . Under the angular variation the first $\theta_{\pi p}$ bin returns 38% high ($+0.67\sigma$). The two low-imbalance cells of $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$ return 0.81 and 0.74 of the alternative truth under the GENIE variation (-0.68σ each), in the direction of the low δp_T bin of the one-dimensional result but within 1σ . Under the angular variation the cell with $\delta p_T > 0.3 \text{ GeV}/c$ and $\theta_p < 0.8$ rad returns 0.39 of the alternative truth, the 61% deviation of the table, which is -0.74σ against the large uncertainty of that cell.

7 Results proposed for approval

The results of this section are Secondary results proposed for approval, subject to the prerequisites of Table 1.

7.1 Total cross section

The total cross section is extracted as a single bin, as in the inclusive analysis (Sec. 15.6 of the inclusive analysis note): nothing is regularised and $A_C = 1$, so the one-bin result is the physical total in the measured phase space and does not depend on an observable (Table 8). A closed-form evaluation on the central-value prediction reproduces the one-bin extraction of that prediction to four digits (0.6269, 0.5506 and 0.5831 for FHC, RHC and combined). The extracted RHC/FHC ratio is 0.873, against 0.878 for the tune.

Table 8: Proton-tagged total cross sections ($10^{-38} \text{ cm}^2/\text{Ar}$) in the measured phase space, averaged over the $\nu_\mu + \bar{\nu}_\mu$ flux integrated above 60 MeV, from the one-bin extraction on pseudo-data. N_{sel} and N_{bkg} are the predicted selected count and background (ν -background + EXT + dirt) of the central-value prediction and ε the selection efficiency; “stat” is the data-statistical term, “syst” all other terms and “total” their quadrature sum; “truth” is the realised truth of the throw and $\chi^2/1$ the closure against it.

Config	N_{sel}	N_{bkg}	ε [%]	σ	stat [%]	syst [%]	total [%]	truth	σ/truth	$\chi^2/1$
FHC	637	305	11.5	0.608 ± 0.256	7.8	41.3	42.0	0.639	0.952	0.014
RHC	786	395	11.4	0.531 ± 0.251	7.4	46.6	47.2	0.532	0.998	0.000
Combined	1423	700	11.5	0.564 ± 0.239	5.4	42.1	42.5	0.578	0.976	0.003

The flux-averaged FHC generator totals in the proton-tagged phase space are 0.50 (GENIE), 0.65 (NuWro), 0.74 (GiBUU) and $0.78 \times 10^{-38} \text{ cm}^2/\text{Ar}$ (NEUT), a factor 1.6 between the lowest and the highest, around the tune value of 0.63.

7.2 Proton angles θ_p and $\theta_{\pi p}$

θ_p uses the stored proton direction; $\theta_{\pi p}$ is written by a reprocessing of the proton-tagged tree that leaves every other branch unchanged. Both are binned in four bins and unfold well, with closure

χ^2 of 3.6/4, 0.09/4 and 1.5/4 for θ_p and 0.29/4, 0.57/4 and 0.24/4 for $\theta_{\pi p}$ in FHC, RHC and combined (Fig. 1). $\theta_{\pi p}$ retains the most shape: the trace of A_C is 2.1–2.2, with three components measured at a signal-to-noise ratio above one in FHC and RHC, at the price of a last bin whose total uncertainty reaches 94% (FHC) and 141% (RHC). θ_p has a trace of 2.1 in FHC and RHC (2.3 combined) and a largest per-bin uncertainty of 41% (FHC) and 84% (RHC); its smallest diagonal passes the 0.68 criterion by 0.002 in RHC. Both distributions are strongly forward peaked, and the generators differ mainly in normalisation, so these observables discriminate between models through their integrals. Ensembles of 100 pseudo-data sets in each configuration give statistical pull widths of 0.94–1.03, and under the two alternative models no bin moves by more than 0.79σ (§6.2 and §6.3). Their binnings follow the rule of Sec. 12.3 of the inclusive analysis note; the screening of the two-dimensional pairs is described in Sec. 11 of the technical supplement.

Proton-tagged CC1 μ 1 $\pi^\pm$: new observables, CV pseudo-data (signal region blind); curves and integrals **BLINDED: CV PSEUDO-DATA**

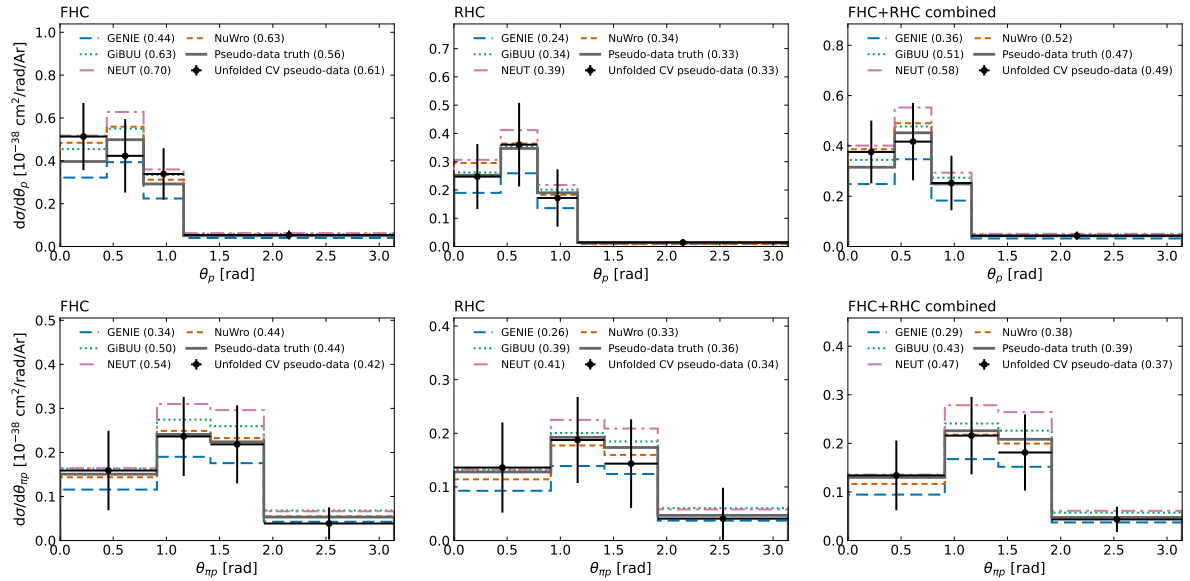


Figure 1: The two proton angles in the three configurations: θ_p (top row) and $\theta_{\pi p}$ (bottom row), for FHC, RHC and combined. Points are the unfolded pseudo-data with the total uncertainty, the grey histogram is the A_C -smeared pseudo-data truth, and the four coloured histograms are the generator predictions; the integrated cross sections are given in the legends.

7.3 Two-dimensional $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$

The double-differential cross section $d^2\sigma/d\theta_p d\delta p_T$ is proposed in the combined configuration only. It is binned in two regions of θ_p (edges 0, 0.8, π rad) inside two of δp_T (0, 0.3 GeV/c and above); the four analysis bins are ordered outer slice by outer slice and extracted with the same machinery as the one-dimensional results. It is one of eight pairs screened (Sec. 11 of the technical supplement). Combining the beam modes raises the conditioning $s_{\min}/s_1$ of its A_C from 0.433 (FHC) and 0.332 (RHC) to 0.611, through the larger sample and the shared flux; the FHC and RHC extractions are Not reported. The combined result has a bin-averaged data-statistical term of 13.3% and per-bin total uncertainties of 29–103%; it closes against the A_C -smeared truth with $\chi^2 = 1.91/4$ and per-bin ratios of 0.70–1.36 (Figs. 2 and 3). Because it uses δp_T , it depends on the muon momentum and carries the muon-momentum-scale term, which moves its cells by at most 16% of their value and 0.20σ and leaves its integral unchanged; its low-imbalance bins share the model sensitivity of P3. Over 100 pseudo-data sets its statistical pull width is 1.04, and under the two alternative models no cell moves by more than 0.74σ (§6.2 and §6.3). Before approval it requires R1 and P1–P3 in addition to the inclusive prerequisites. Its covariance, A_C

and curves are released as `1p_COMB_thetap_dpt2d`.

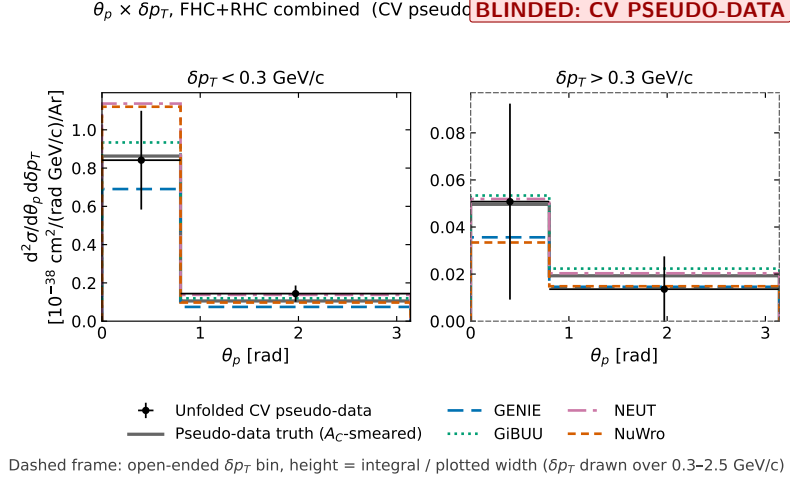


Figure 2: $d^2\sigma/d\theta_p d\delta p_T$ in the combined configuration, as slices in δp_T . Points are the unfolded pseudo-data with the total uncertainty, the grey histogram is the A_C -smeared truth of the pseudo-data and the coloured histograms are the generator predictions, smeared with A_C . Each slice has its own vertical scale.

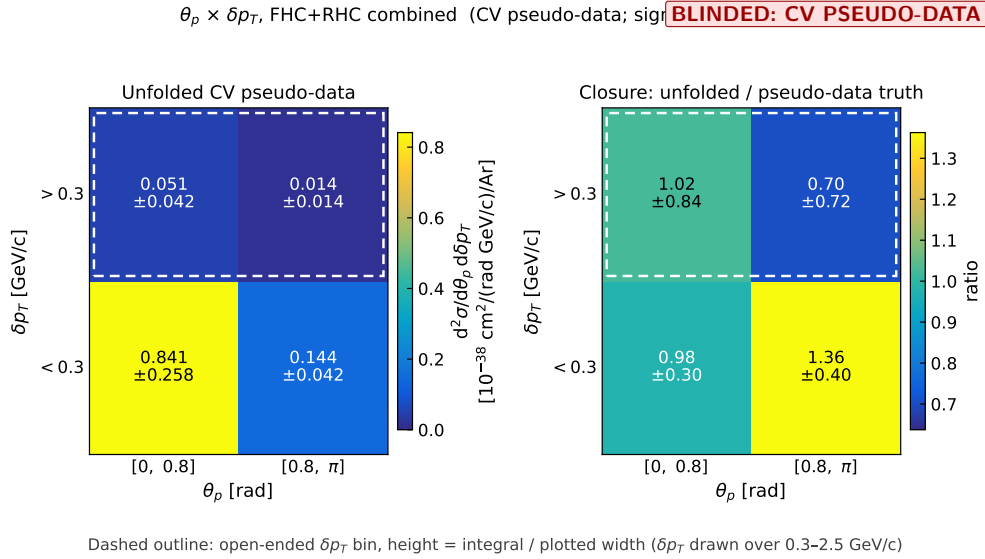


Figure 3: The same result as a map: $d^2\sigma/d\theta_p d\delta p_T$ per cell with its total uncertainty (left) and the ratio to the A_C -smeared truth (right). Cells are drawn with equal size and labelled by their ranges.

8 Validation-only products

8.1 Differential cross sections

The differential results of this section are Validation-only products: they carry their full covariances and are released, but they are not proposed for approval until the prerequisites listed for them in Table 1 are met. Tables 9–11 give the integrated cross section of each unfolded result and its closure against the A_C -smeared truth of the pseudo-data, and Figs. 4–6 show the six observables specific to this sample.

Table 9: FHC proton-tagged results from pseudo-data. σ_{int} is the integrated unfolded cross section over the measured phase space (10^{-38} cm²/Ar); “unf./truth” is the ratio of its integral to that of the A_C -smeared truth; χ^2 compares the unfolded pseudo-data with the A_C -smeared truth bin by bin (ndf = number of bins). The upper block lists the observables specific to the sample, the lower block the muon and pion observables of the inclusive analysis. The proton angles are in §7.2.

Observable	σ_{int}	unf./truth	χ^2/ndf
W_{had}	0.527	0.96	0.04/2
δp_T	0.469	0.98	0.19/2
$\delta \alpha_T$	0.476	0.93	0.05/2
$\delta \phi_T$	0.449	1.00	0.25/3
p_n	0.476	0.95	0.77/2
p_p	0.470	0.98	0.01/3
p_μ	0.476	1.00	0.43/6
p_π	0.493	0.96	0.02/2
$\cos \theta_\mu$	0.499	1.18	2.22/8
$\cos \theta_\pi$	0.383	0.96	0.36/4
$\theta_{\mu\pi}$	0.451	0.98	0.32/5

Table 10: As Table 9, for RHC.

Observable	σ_{int}	unf./truth	χ^2/ndf
W_{had}	0.402	0.96	0.17/2
δp_T	0.418	1.10	0.52/2
$\delta \alpha_T$	0.438	1.08	0.19/2
$\delta \phi_T$	0.495	1.09	0.16/3
p_n	0.391	1.00	1.06/2
p_p	0.387	1.02	0.06/3
p_μ	0.344	0.93	0.40/6
p_π	0.429	1.09	1.21/2
$\cos \theta_\mu$	0.330	1.02	1.34/8
$\cos \theta_\pi$	0.365	1.10	6.01/4
$\theta_{\mu\pi}$	0.367	0.96	0.14/5

Table 11: As Table 9, for the combined configuration.

Observable	σ_{int}	unf./truth	χ^2/ndf
W_{had}	0.464	0.97	0.05/2
δp_T	0.566	1.15	0.56/2
$\delta \alpha_T$	0.453	1.00	0.02/2
$\delta \phi_T$	0.567	1.06	0.23/3
p_n	0.449	1.02	1.81/2
p_p	0.433	1.00	0.03/3
p_μ	0.400	0.98	0.46/6
p_π	0.459	1.02	0.48/2
$\cos \theta_\mu$	0.391	1.01	3.11/8
$\cos \theta_\pi$	0.376	1.01	3.89/4
$\theta_{\mu\pi}$	0.428	1.01	0.17/5

The integrated cross sections of the differential results are A_C -suppressed and depend on the observable, because each A_C changes the normalisation by a different factor. They range from 0.36 to 0.57 in the combined configuration, below the one-bin total of 0.564, and are not independent measurements of one quantity. For the same reason the ratio of RHC to FHC integrals of one observable is not the RHC/FHC cross-section ratio, which is taken from the one-bin totals. The combined result lies between the FHC and RHC results for ten of the twelve extractions; for δp_T (0.566 against 0.469 and 0.418) and $\delta \phi_T$ (0.567 against 0.449 and 0.495) it lies above both, which is allowed for an independent extraction with its own A_C and is well inside the 30% uncertainties.

The generator predictions are computed at truth level from the event-level final state of each generator (GENIE [2, 4] and GiBUU [6] natively, NuWro [5] and NEUT [10, 7] from their event vectors), with the proton-tagged signal definition and the observable definitions of the selection (Sec. 10.1 of the technical supplement), and combined over the ν_μ and $\bar{\nu}_\mu$ flux of the configuration; each one-dimensional prediction integrates to the proton-tagged total of its generator. All curves, the tune and the pseudo-data truth included, are smeared with A_C (Sec. 10.2 of the technical supplement). In the reported binnings the generators differ mostly in normalisation. The tune and all four generators are compatible with the unfolded pseudo-data in every panel and configuration: with the official covariance the largest χ^2 is 4.1 on two bins (GENIE, combined p_n), GENIE having the lowest normalisation, and all others are below 2.6. The present exposure therefore does not discriminate between the generators' treatments of Fermi motion and final-state interactions. A comparison in which data and prediction used different axes would show shape differences of a factor of several, so the frame is stated with every transverse quantity.

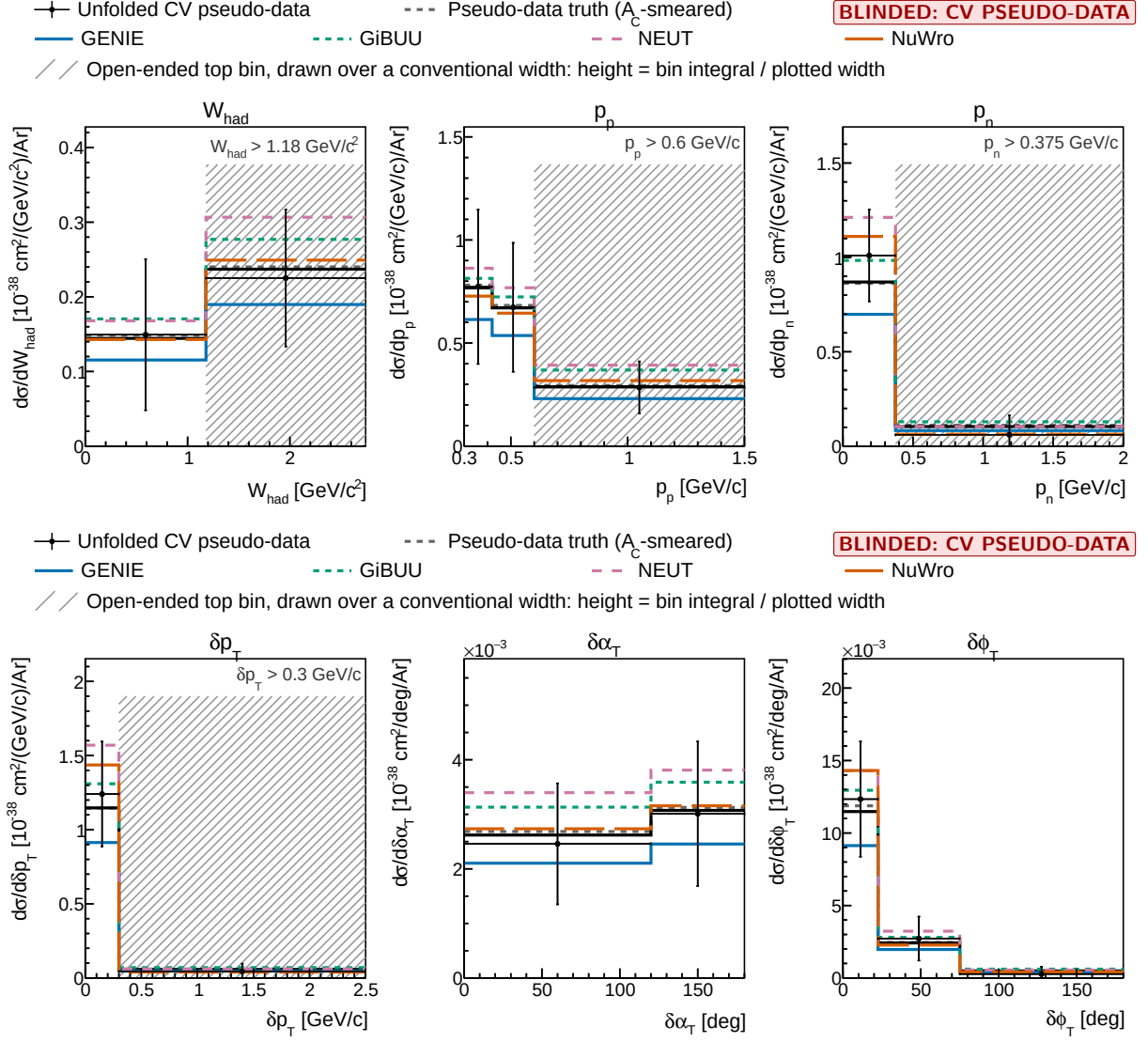


Figure 4: Proton-tagged differential cross sections, FHC: W_{had} , p_p and p_n (top) and δp_T , $\delta \alpha_T$ and $\delta \phi_T$ (bottom). Unfolded pseudo-data (points) are compared with the A_C -smeared pseudo-data truth (grey dashed), the MicroBooNE tune [3] (black) and the GENIE (blue), GiBUU (green), NEUT (purple) and NuWro (orange) predictions for the same phase space. The last bin of each open-ended observable is hatched and labelled with its range; its height is the bin integral divided by the plotted width. $\delta \alpha_T$ rises towards 180° , the signature of final-state interactions.

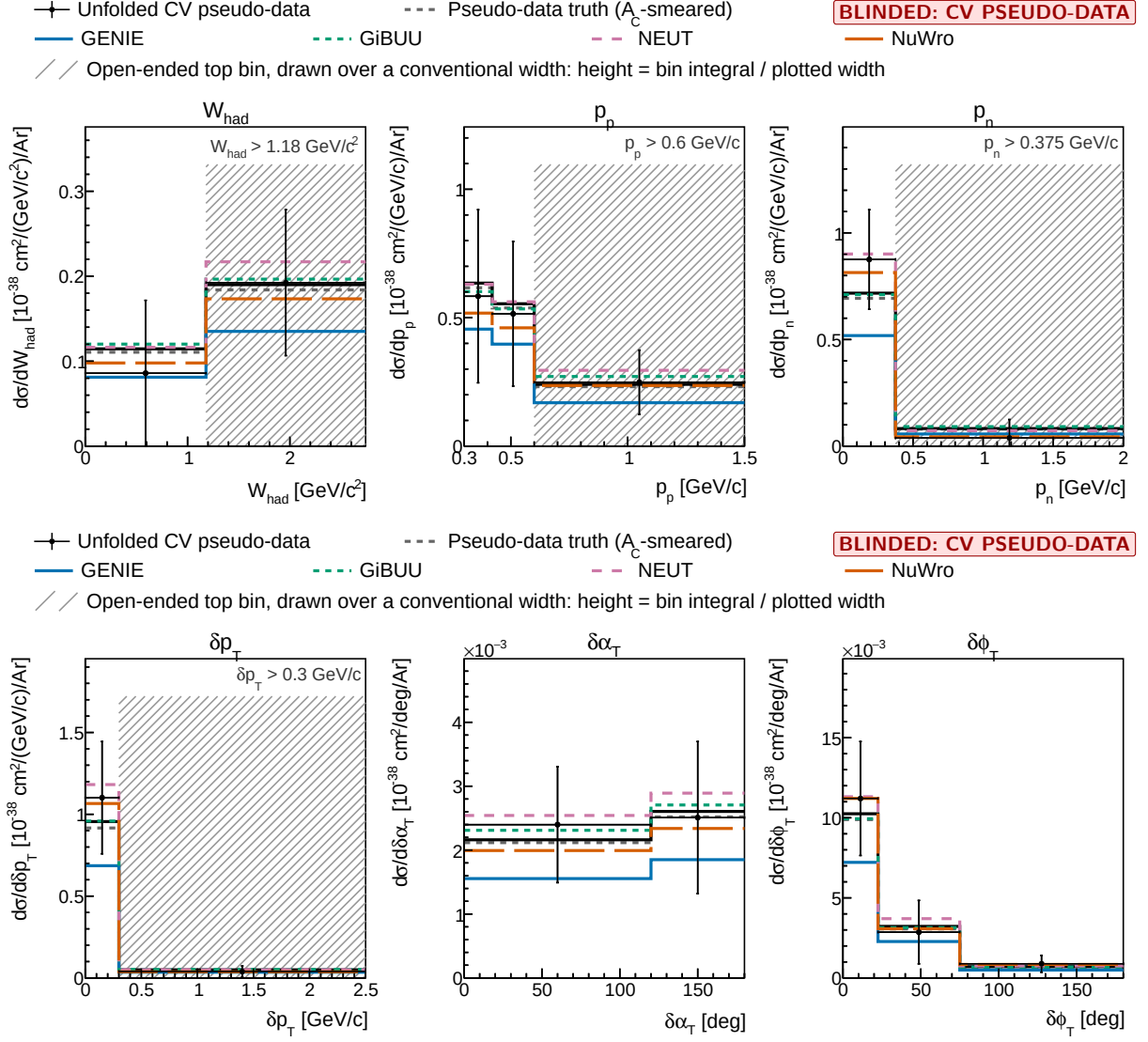


Figure 5: Proton-tagged differential cross sections, RHC: W_{had} , p_p and p_n (top) and δp_T , $\delta \alpha_T$ and $\delta \phi_T$ (bottom). Unfolded pseudo-data (points) are compared with the A_C -smeared pseudo-data truth (grey dashed), the MicroBooNE tune (black) and the GENIE (blue), GiBUU (green), NEUT (purple) and NuWro (orange) predictions for the same phase space. The last bin of each open-ended observable is hatched and labelled with its range; its height is the bin integral divided by the plotted width.

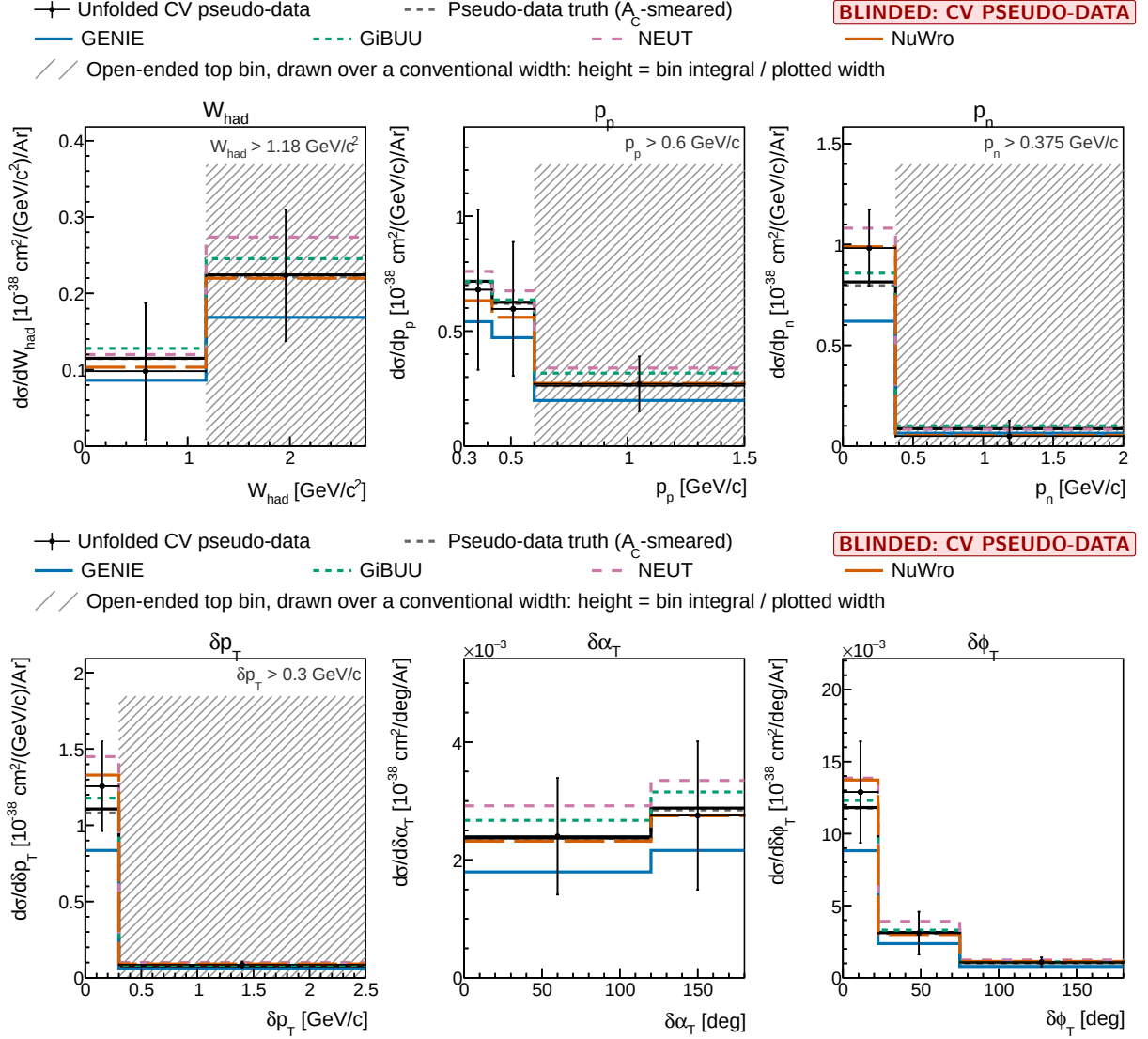


Figure 6: Proton-tagged differential cross sections, the combined configuration: W_{had} , p_p and p_n (top) and δp_T , $\delta\alpha_T$ and $\delta\phi_T$ (bottom). Unfolded pseudo-data (points) are compared with the A_C -smeared pseudo-data truth (grey dashed), the MicroBooNE tune (black) and the GENIE (blue), GiBUU (green), NEUT (purple) and NuWro (orange) predictions for the same phase space. The last bin of each open-ended observable is hatched and labelled with its range; its height is the bin integral divided by the plotted width.

9 Products not reported

No differential $W_{\pi p}$ result is reported. The topology-level one-bin total cross section of the proton-tagged sample remains measurable (§7.1), but it is not described as a $W_{\pi p}$ measurement. Of the two-dimensional pairs screened, those built on $W_{\pi p}$ and $\theta_{\pi p} \times \delta p_T$ cannot be inverted or carry no usable information, and the FHC and RHC extractions of $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$ are not shape measurements (Sec. 11 of the technical supplement); none of them is reported.

9.1 The differential $W_{\pi p}$ shape is not reported

The pion–proton invariant mass would show the $\Delta(1232)$ directly and motivated the proton-tagged subsample. At the present exposure its shape cannot be measured with any binning tried. The six-bin scheme that resolves the resonance region has a highest bin with a 2% diagonal,

so nearly every event reconstructed there comes from another true bin. Two bins restore the response but leave no shape: the best split, at 1.20 GeV/ c^2 , passes the 0.50 criterion by 0.003, and its second Wiener filter factor is 0.29 in FHC and 0.27 in RHC. A closure test against the A_C -smeared truth cannot change this, since it tests whether the response was inverted correctly and cannot restore information the response does not contain. The six-bin extractions remain in the result directory, flagged in `index_extractions.tsv`, and their closure and generator curves are shown as diagnostics in Sec. 9.1 of the technical supplement; they are not results. The sample supports the topology-level one-bin total and, as a validation-only product, W_{had} in two regions.

10 Prerequisites

Table 12 lists every prerequisite with its criterion, owner, evidence and what it blocks; it is the same table as in the analysis note. The proton-tagged results proposed for approval require the inclusive prerequisites U1–U3 and U5–U7, U4 for $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$, and the proton-tagged items listed for each in Table 1.

The existing inclusive control regions do not validate the dominant proton-candidate misidentification mode of this sample: the multi- π region constrains the proton $\rightarrow$ pion direction, while the 12.6% of wrong candidates come mainly from the pion $\rightarrow$ proton direction (§3.1). Until an inverted-proton-PID region is defined and validated (P1), no proton-tagged result is unblinded, and the distributions whose migrations are dominated by the proton-candidate assignment, θ_p , $\theta_{\pi p}$ and $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$, carry the additional term of P2.

Two concerns about the transverse observables are separate and have separate remedies. The first is the validity of the reconstruction: W_{had} and p_n use a residual-mass prescription derived for quasi-elastic kinematics, and whether the reconstructed quantities follow the physical quantities they are named for in pion production has not been shown; the remedy is a truth-level validation or a redefinition of the observables as the proxies they are (P4). The second is model sensitivity: the low δp_T and p_n bins move by 1.1–1.2 σ under the coherent GENIE variation while their truth moves by 1% (§6.3); the remedy is an explicit model term in the covariance, the removal of those bins, or an independent-generator test that shows no such shift (P3).

Table 12: Prerequisites, their criteria and what each blocks. U: all results; P: proton-tagged results; V: results proposed since the last validation round; R: reporting decisions.

ID	Prerequisite	Criterion	Owner; evidence	Blocks
U1	Absolute flux normalisation	Written confirmation that the integrated $\nu_\mu + \bar{\nu}_\mu$ fluxes above 60 MeV used for the normalisation (FHC 6.81159, RHC 6.44646, combined $6.59691 \times 10^{-10} \text{ cm}^{-2} \text{ POT}^{-1}$) are the PPFX-corrected central values that correspond to the per-event PPFX weights	NuMI flux group (flux contact); written statement	Unblinding
U2	Control regions	The four inclusive control regions compared with beam-on data under the frozen procedure, and any discrepancy treated as that procedure prescribes	Analysers and conveners; control-region comparison	Unblinding
U3	Independent-generator closure	A NuWro overlay with the full detector simulation, validated against standalone NuWro on the same flux, unfolded with the nominal response: every bin holding at least 10% of the largest truth within 1 σ of its total uncertainty, and every integral within its uncertainty	Analysers, with the production group for the overlay; closure tables for every primary and proposed result	Unblinding

ID	Prerequisite	Criterion	Owner; evidence	Blocks
U4	MCS momentum scale	Comparison of the MCS and range momenta of contained muons in data and simulation: the difference of the MCS scale within the $\pm 5\%$ of the covariance term, or the term enlarged to the observed difference	Analysers; MCS-to-range comparison	Unblinding of results that use the muon momentum
U5	Beam-on exposure	POT and trigger counts of every beam-on file summed over the runs the file contains, and checked against the beam database to better than 1%	Analysers, with the beam-data contact; per-run exposure table	Unblinding
U6	Reproduction	The result set rebuilt from empty caches reproduces every released bin to 10^{-9}	Analysers; rebuild log	Unblinding
U7	Terms outside the covariance	The beamline-geometry flux term (1.6–3.3%), the beam-off gate-ratio term and the Run-2 beam-off stand-in term included in the released covariance	Analysers; released covariance	Publication
P1	Proton mis-assignment control region	An inverted-proton-PID control region at exactly one pion candidate, validated with pseudo-data and compared with beam-on data under the frozen procedure; the rate of wrong proton candidates in the simulation consistent with the data within its uncertainty, or corrected under that procedure	Analysers; region definition and comparison	Unblinding of every proton-tagged result
P2	Wrong-candidate term for the proton angles	The fraction of wrong proton candidates varied by its uncertainty from P1, and the resulting change of every bin of θ_p , $\theta_{\pi p}$ and $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$ added to their covariance	Analysers; covariance term	Unblinding of θ_p , $\theta_{\pi p}$, $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$
P3	Model sensitivity of the low-imbalance bins	With an explicit model term in the covariance, the alternative-model bias of the low δp_T and p_n bins below 1σ ; or those bins removed; or U3 showing no such shift	Analysers; covariance term or closure	Unblinding of $\theta_p \times \delta p_T$; promotion of δp_T , p_n
P4	Reconstruction validity of W_{had} and p_n	For pion production, a truth-level study showing that each reconstructed proxy follows the quantity it is named for (hadronic invariant mass, initial-nucleon momentum) with a bias smaller than the bin width in every bin; otherwise the observable redefined as the proxy, with the same prescription at truth level	Analysers; truth-level study	Promotion of W_{had} , p_n
V1	Validation of the newly proposed results	Ensembles (pull widths consistent with one within the ensemble precision, nominal coverage) and the alternative-model test (per-bin bias below 1σ , or flagged and treated) for θ_p , $\theta_{\pi p}$ and the two two-dimensional results	Analysers; ensemble and alternative-model tables of the two notes	Complete (2026-09-28): pull widths 0.94–1.04, largest bias 0.79 σ
R1	Results in the combined configuration only	A collaboration decision on quoting the two two-dimensional results only in the combined configuration, since their FHC and RHC responses cannot be inverted	Conveners; decision recorded	Approval of the two-dimensional results

11 Summary

The proton-tagged selection adds to the inclusive selection a contained proton candidate above 0.3 GeV/c, at 11.5% efficiency and 50–52% purity; the candidate is the leading true proton in 82% of selected signal events. The one-bin total cross section, $d\sigma/d\theta_p$ and $d\sigma/d\theta_{\pi p}$ in the three configurations, and $d^2\sigma/d\theta_p d\delta p_T$ in the combined configuration are Secondary results proposed for approval; the other proton-tagged extractions are Validation-only products, and no differential

$W_{\pi p}$ result is reported. The extraction closes, and ensembles give correctly sized statistical uncertainties. The low-imbalance bins of δp_T and p_n are model-sensitive at the level of their uncertainty. Every proton-tagged result stays blind until the inverted-proton-PID control region exists and the prerequisites of Table 12 that apply to it are complete.

Glossary

Signal definition The set of particles leaving the nucleus that counts as the process being measured, with momentum thresholds and a fiducial requirement. It makes no statement about the interaction mechanism, because final-state interactions mix mechanisms and only the final state is observable.

Fake data / pseudo-data A simulated dataset used in place of beam-on data while the analysis is blind. Here it is a Poisson throw: each simulated event is replicated a Poisson-distributed number of times with mean equal to its weight at data exposure, so the sample has the statistical fluctuations of a real dataset.

Blind The signal region has not been examined in beam-on data. Every plotted “data” point of the signal region is fake data.

Beam-on, beam-off (EXT), dirt Beam-on data are recorded in the beam spill; beam-off data are recorded between spills and measure cosmic-ray activity; “dirt” is simulated neutrino interactions outside the cryostat whose products enter the detector. The prediction is neutrino simulation + beam-off + dirt.

Gate ratio The factor scaling beam-off data to the beam-on exposure: the ratio of the number of beam-on to beam-off trigger gates in a running period.

Tune, central value (CV) The MicroBooNE tune is the collaboration’s adjusted GENIE model; the central value is the nominal prediction from it. “CV weight” is the per-event weight that turns the raw simulation into the tuned prediction.

Safe-weight rule Any event weight that is non-finite, negative or above 30 is replaced by 1. One rule, applied everywhere, so that the prediction and every pseudo-data throw agree.

Universe One alternative version of the prediction with a systematic parameter varied. A *multisim* is a set of hundreds of universes drawn randomly from the parameter uncertainties; a *unisim* is a single $\pm 1\sigma$ variation of one parameter. PPFX universes vary the flux; GENIE universes the interaction model; reinteraction universes the hadron transport.

Detector variations (detVar) Dedicated simulation samples with one aspect of the detector response changed (light yield, recombination, space charge or wire response), used to estimate the detector uncertainty.

Migration matrix, efficiency, smearceptance The migration matrix M_{ij} is the probability that an event in true bin j is reconstructed in bin i ; the efficiency ε_j is the fraction of true bin j that is selected at all. Their product $S_{ij} = \varepsilon_j M_{ij}$ is the response the unfolding inverts; we call it the smearceptance matrix.

Migration diagonal The fraction of the selected events of a true bin that are reconstructed in the same bin (the diagonal of the column-normalised M). A binning is accepted only if every bin’s diagonal exceeds 0.68.

Unfolding, Wiener-SVD Solving for the true spectrum given the reconstructed one and the response. A plain inversion amplifies statistical noise; Wiener-SVD regularises it with a filter built from the simulation, trading a small bias for a large reduction in variance.

Additional-smearing matrix A_C The price of regularisation, made explicit: the unfolded result estimates $A_C T$ rather than the truth T . A prediction must be multiplied by A_C before it is compared with the result. A_C is released with every extraction.

Not normalisation-preserving The rows of A_C do not sum to one, so the integral of an unfolded differential result is not the total cross section and differs between observables of the same sample. The total is measured separately.

One-bin extraction The total cross section, extracted with a single true bin covering the whole phase space. Nothing is regularised, $A_C = 1$, and the result is the physical total.

Conditioning, $s_{\min}/s_1$, rank-deficient The ratio of the smallest to the largest singular value of the regularised response. Near zero, some direction in the true spectrum cannot be recovered from the data at all (rank-deficient); the result in that direction is the prior. A binning can pass the migration-diagonal criterion and still be unusable here.

Closure Unfolding pseudo-data and checking that the truth comes back. Closure against the A_C -smeared truth tests the implementation; it cannot test whether the model is right, because the same model is on both sides.

Covariance The matrix of uncertainties and their correlations between bins, one per systematic source, propagated through the unfolding. “Nominal configured covariance” means the sum over the sources implemented in the analysis; the sources known to be missing are listed in the limitations.

Flux-averaged cross section The cross section averaged over the neutrino energy spectrum of the beam, per argon nucleus, in the stated phase space. It depends on the flux, which is why each horn configuration is a separate measurement.

FHC, RHC Forward and reverse horn current: the two polarities of the NuMI focusing horns, giving a neutrino-dominated and an antineutrino-enriched beam.

Beam frame All angles are measured about the neutrino direction, which at MicroBooNE’s off-axis position is 28° from the detector z axis.

Control region, sideband A sample selected by inverting one requirement of the signal selection, so that it is disjoint from the signal region and enriched in one background. It can be inspected on beam-on data while the signal region stays blind.

Transverse kinematic imbalance (TKI) Variables built from the momenta transverse to the neutrino direction of the lepton and the hadronic system: δp_T , $\delta \alpha_T$, $\delta \phi_T$ and the inferred nucleon momentum p_n . They isolate nuclear effects from the unknown neutrino energy.

LLR particle identification The log-likelihood-ratio score built from track dE/dx that separates protons from muons and pions.

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